Some major **Active Volcanoes**: Mount Vesuvius, Mt. Stromboli and Mt. Etna in Italy and Mauna Loa and Mauna Kea in Hawaii Islands.

Sedimentary Rocks



Sedimentary Rocks

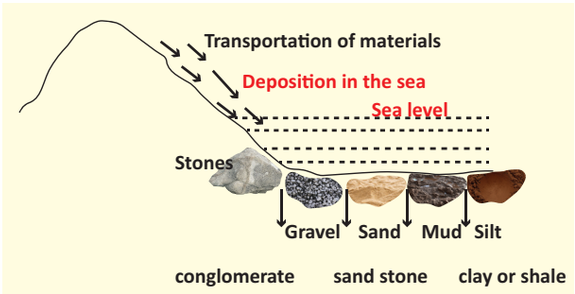
The word **'Sedimentary'** has been derived from Latin word **'Sedimentum'** means settling down. The sedimentary rocks are formed by the sediments derived and deposited by various agents (wind, running water, glaciers). Due to high temperature and pressure, the undisturbed sediments of long period cemented to form sedimentary rocks. Sedimentary rocks consist of many layers which were formed by the sediments deposited at different periods. As it consists of many strata, it is also known as **'Stratified rocks'.**



Sedimentary rocks are the important source of natural resources like coal, oil and natural gas.

Characteristics of Sedimentary rocks

1. They have many layers.
2. They are non-crystalline rocks.
3. They contain fossils.
4. They are soft and get eroded easily



Formation of Sedimentary Rocks



Oldest sedimentary rocks of the world has been identified in Greenland and estimated as 3.9 billion years old.

Types of Sedimentary Rocks

1. Organic Sedimentary Rocks

These rocks are formed as a result of the decomposition of dead plants and animals. It contains fossils. Chalk, Talc, Dolomite and Limestone rocks are of this category.

2. Mechanical Sedimentary Rocks

These rocks are formed due to the disintegration of igneous and metamorphic rocks. The natural agents erode and transport these rocks and deposit them at some places. After a long period of time, they cemented to form rocks. Sandstone and Shale are the examples of rocks of this type.

3. Chemical Sedimentary rocks

These are formed by precipitating of minerals from water. It is formed usually through evaporation of chemical rich solutions. These rocks are also called as evaporates. Gypsum is an example of this kind.

Metamorphic Rocks

The word Metamorphic is derived from two Greek words "Meta" and "Morpha", Meta means change and Morpha means shape. When Igneous and sedimentary rocks subject to high temperature and pressure, the original rocks get altered to form a new kind of rock called metamorphic rocks. Metamorphism is of two types. They are

1. Thermal Metamorphism
2. Dynamic Metamorphism

If the change in the rocks is mainly caused by high temperature, the process is called as 'Thermal Metamorphism'.

If the change in the rock is mainly caused by high pressure, the process is called as 'Dynamic Metamorphism'.

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